

CASE ID: 202405710002

EPISODE NAME: China anti-dumping plastics US

2024/05/19 - Present

Sender: China (710)

Target: United States (2)

Issue: Retaliation (16)

Final Outcome: Ongoing

Summary:

On 2024/05/19, China's Ministry of Commerce launched an anti-dumping probe into POM copolymers from the United States. China found US firms guilty of anti-dumping on 2025/01/16, and imposed anti-dumping tariffs on 2025/05/18.

Narrative:

On 2024/05/19, China's Ministry of Commerce launched an anti-dumping probe into POM copolymers from the European Union, United States, Japan and Taiwan.¹

China's move followed US President Biden's decision to increase tariffs on Chinese electric vehicles and solar cells.² It also followed the European Union's battery EV anti-subsidy investigation, which began on 2023/10/04,³ and would eventually conclude with finding China guilty and announcing countervailing tariffs on 2024/06/11.⁴

On 2025/01/16, China announced that it found the US guilty of dumping plastics into the Chinese economy, and that it would impose anti-dumping tariffs on plastics manufactured by US firms of 74.9 percent.⁵ The sanctions were officially imposed on 2025/05/18, and remain in place.⁶

¹ Li, Qiaoyi, and Wu, Sarah. "China launches anti-dumping probe into EU, US, Japan, Taiwan plastics," *Reuters*, May 19th, 2024.

<https://www.reuters.com/business/china-launches-anti-dumping-probe-into-eu-us-japan-taiwan-chemicals-2024-05-19/>.

² Ibid.

³ "EU anti-subsidy probe into electric vehicle imports from China." *European Parliament*, October 18th, 2023.

[https://www.europarl.europa.eu/thinktank/en/document/EPRS_ATA\(2023\)754553](https://www.europarl.europa.eu/thinktank/en/document/EPRS_ATA(2023)754553).

⁴ "Commission investigation provisionally concludes that electric vehicle value chains in China benefit from unfair subsidies." *European Commission*, June 11th, 2024.

https://ec.europa.eu/commission/presscorner/detail/en/ip_24_3231.

⁵ "China Imposes Provisional Duties on US, EU, Japan, Taiwan Industrial Plastics." *Reuters*, January 16th, 2025.

www.reuters.com/business/china-imposes-provisional-duties-us-eu-japan-taiwan-industrial-plastics-2025-01-16/.

⁶ "China slaps anti-dumping duties on plastics from the U.S., EU, Japan, and Taiwan." *CNBC*, May 18th, 2025.

<https://www.cnbc.com/2025/05/18/china-slaps-anti-dumping-duties-on-plastics-from-us-eu-japan-taiwan.html>.